

Tofu Day-Of Prep

Extra-firm only · freeze-thaw → brine → press → sear · 2×/week

Step 1 — Thaw

Method	Time	Notes
Fridge overnight	8–12 h	Preferred — slow thaw preserves texture best
Cold water fast	30–60 min	Submerge sealed bag in cold water

Step 2 — Salt Brine

Water	Salt	Boil Level	Time
4 cups	1 tsp	Full rolling boil	3–5 min
2 cups	½ tsp	Full rolling boil	3–5 min
8 cups	2 tsp	Full rolling boil	3–5 min

Full boil expels ice-crystal water and opens pores — salt seasons from inside out. Remove slabs, transfer to clean surface.

Step 3 — Press

5 minutes — slabs on a clean towel, heavy pan on top. Most water exits during the brine; this is the final dry.

Step 4 — Marinate (Optional — 15–20 min)

Option	Recipe
Tamari	2 tbsp tamari + 1 ginger cube (melted) + 1 tsp ACV — soak 15 min
Dry rub	Spice mix (turmeric + cumin + coriander + Kashmiri chili) rubbed onto slab — no wait time

Step 5 — Flash Sear (Allicin Pulse)

Clock	Action
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00:00	Crush 2–3 garlic cloves — REST 10 MINUTES (allicin formation — non-negotiable)
00:10	COLD START — 2 tbsp avocado oil + methi seeds + chili + rested garlic into COLD pan
00:11	Turn to LOW — bloom 5 min until garlic barely sizzles
00:16	Turn to MEDIUM-HIGH — add tofu slabs — sear 60–90 sec per side until golden crust
00:25	Off heat — tear 5–6 fresh mint (<i>Mentha arvensis</i>) leaves over hot tofu
00:26	Serve immediately with Peppermint Jaljeera

■ **10-minute garlic rest is non-negotiable — alliinase needs time to convert alliin → allicin before heat destroys it. Crush first, then prep everything else.**

Wet Curry Variant

At 00:25: add 2–3 tbsp coconut milk, stir 30–60 sec into a glaze. Subtract 1 tbsp oil from the 14:30 salad dressing (Lipid Substitution Rule).

